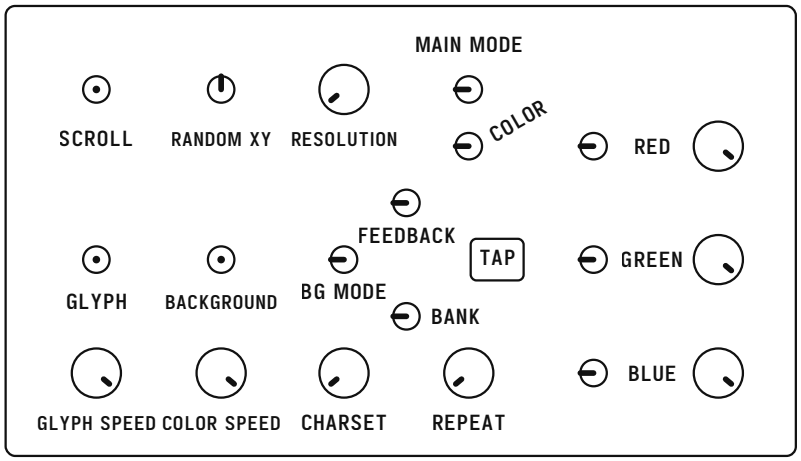
Cells

Cellular video synthesis based on John Conway's *Game of Life* (1970)

01 / Start here



1 / Set the controls as shown.

2 / First steps

BACKGROUND selects the shape. CHARSET sets its size or the line width.

RANDOM XY ⊗ stops adding shapes.

SCROLL and GLYPH move the image.

GLYPH SPEED sets the speed of shapes and movement.

COLOR SPEED sets the rate of color changes.

MAIN MODE changes how colors spread.

BANK selects the colors. REPEAT changes the palette with BANK ⊗ or →.

02 / Control reference

Shapes and movement

RANDOM XY
↑ Adds solid shapes
⊗ Evolution without new shapes
↓ Inversion, see the dedicated section

BACKGROUND
↑ Horizontal/vertical lines (RANDOM XY ↑/↓)
⊗ Rectangles
↓ Circles

CHARSET
Turn toward ↻ to enlarge shapes or increase the line width.

SCROLL · horizontal
↑ Spreads the image apart
⊗ Off
↓ Pulls the image together

GLYPH · vertical
↑ Spreads the image apart
⊗ Off
↓ Pulls the image together

GLYPH SPEED
↻: speeds up new shapes, SCROLL and GLYPH (25 to 60 fps)

FEEDBACK · gaps left by SCROLL/GLYPH
← Filled with black
⊗ Reuse pixels from the same half
→ Reuse pixels from the opposite half

Resolution

Select resolution: 320×240 / 180×120 / 160×120 / 120×80 / 80×60

TAP · image and tempo

Press TAP to clear the image.
GLYPH SPEED at ↺↺: TAP tempo (smoothed over 2 to 8 presses)
Autonomous mode ON/OFF, see below.

Video output

RED / GREEN / BLUE

Knobs · ↻ brightness (max: ↻↻)

Switches · ← direct · ⊗ off · → 45 Ω

Growth and colors

MAIN MODE
← System 1: *Angulatoire*
⊗ System 2: *Crystal Chaos*
→ System 3: *Diamonds*

COLOR · new cells
← Random color at COLOR SPEED
⊗ Eight-color cycle
→ Cycle shuffled each time you switch to →

COLOR SPEED
↻↻: random color for each pixel or shape
↺: slower color changes
Active with COLOR ← and BG MODE ←

BG MODE · shapes
← Random color
⊗ White
→ Black

BANK · palettes
← Original colors
⊗ Three colors
→ Five colors

REPEAT
BANK ←: ↻ slows SCROLL and GLYPH
BANK ⊗ / →: selects a palette

Inversion · RANDOM XY ↓

BG MODE ←: keeps the outside. ⊗: clears the outside of colored shapes.
With BG MODE ← or ⊗, black stays black. An entirely black shape turns white.
BG MODE →: black shapes without inversion.
Lines use BG MODE without inversion.

RESOLUTION · automatic clearing
Resolution stays fixed. ↻ raises the nonblack pixel threshold for clearing the image
↺↺: no automatic clearing
After entering this mode, turn RESOLUTION to activate the threshold.

Autonomous mode

Set all 4 vertical switches to ⊗, then hold TAP for at least 10 s to enter/exit autonomous mode.
Romejko gradually changes the controls on its own, indefinitely.
RESOLUTION is unaffected. You can still turn it.